Chemistry Word Lab: Why iron rusts

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · oxygen, water and metal



1 BRAIN TEASERS: ANSWERS

1. **RUST**. Iron rusts when it touches oxygen and water.
2. **PAINT**. Paint keeps air and water away from the metal.
3. **STEEL**. Steel is made mostly of iron, so it can rust.

2 TEACHER NOTE

Rusting is a chemical reaction with both oxygen and water. Extension: a nail in dry air with no water will not rust quickly.

3 WORD HUNT: SOLVED

12 columns, 8 rows

G	S	T	E	E	L	I	I	O	T	T	S
E	P	E	A	O	F	R	A	T	R	M	J
N	I	C	U	X	Z	O	N	I	E	A	U
P	A	M	T	Y	C	N	N	B	P	Z	T
Z	A	O	E	G	O	I	L	E	A	I	R
T	S	Y	G	E	G	A	O	F	I	N	N
Y	M	B	U	N	S	J	R	P	N	C	A
W	A	T	E	R	U	S	T	T	T	T	K

- **RUST: across, row 8, column 5**
- **PAINT: down, row 4, column 10**
- **STEEL: across, row 1, column 2**
- **IRON: down, row 1, column 7**
- **OXYGEN: down, row 2, column 5**
- **WATER: across, row 8, column 1**
- **ZINC: down, row 4, column 11**
- **OIL: across, row 5, column 6**

4 SPEAK: SAMPLE ANSWERS

Accept any correct answer in the child's own words

1. What two things does iron need to rust?
Iron needs oxygen and water to rust.

2. Why do cars near the sea rust quickly?
Salt water makes iron rust faster.

3. How can we stop rust?
We can stop rust with paint, oil or a layer of zinc.